

SENATE BILL 879

By Reeves

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 71,
Chapter 5, Part 3, relative to food assistance.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 71-5-318, is amended by deleting subsections (b) and (c) and substituting:

(b) The department shall annually identify any federal waivers it deems necessary to alleviate any federal regulatory limitations it identifies pursuant to subsection (a), and shall, no later than October 31 of each year, as applicable, submit applications to the federal government for such waivers.

(c) On or before December 31 of each year, the department shall submit a report to the chair of the health and welfare committee of the senate, the chair of the committee of the house of representatives with subject matter jurisdiction over health, and the legislative librarian that details its findings pursuant to subsection (a), describes any waiver applications it has submitted pursuant to subsection (b) and the status of such applications, and includes recommendations to the general assembly for any statutory changes the department deems necessary to facilitate efficient processing and approval of applications and delivery of benefits for the food assistance program.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.